

World oceans

The oceans of the world occupy more than two-thirds of the globe and contain a colossal volume of water, so there is far more ocean than land on planet Earth. They extend from the equator to the polar regions, and range from the warm, shallow coral seas of the tropics to the icebound waters of the Arctic and Antarctic.

Arctic Ocean

Shrinking ice



Area 5.4 million sq miles (14 million sq km)

Average depth 3,953 ft (1,205 m)

Maximum depth 15,305 ft (4,665 m) in Eurasia Basin

The Arctic is a frozen ocean surrounded by continents. In winter, the entire surface is covered by floating ice, but much of this melts away in summer, leaving an area of

permanent ice around the North Pole. However, this permanent summer ice is dwindling each year as the effects of climate change warm the planet.

▼ FLOATING ICE

Small icebergs that have cracked away from glaciers float among the fractured sea ice of the Arctic Ocean.

